Blood Relations

Decode the Phrase

break it one link at a time!

Quantitative Aptitude: Logical Reasoning

In simple words *Read the statement step by step, one relation at a time, and draw a small family tree.*

1 Blood Relation

A relation by birth within a family, such as parent, child, brother, sister, grandparent, uncle, aunt, cousin.

in-laws are by marriage

2 Family Tree

A diagram that uses symbols for male and female, horizontal lines for marriage and siblings, and vertical lines for generations, used to solve relation puzzles.

always draw it!

1. Father's or mother's father = grandfather; their mother = grandmother.
2. Father's or mother's brother = uncle; their sister = aunt (blood relations).
3. Children of uncles and aunts are cousins; gender is not fixed by the word.
4. Gender of a person is often not given – never assume it.



Swipe for the summary →

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Relation Quick Table

Blood Relations: Decoding Relation Phrases

learn these 5 by heart

Phrase	Relation	Generation
Father's father	Paternal grandfather	+2
Mother's brother	Maternal uncle (mama)	+1
Father's sister	Paternal aunt (bua)	+1
Mother's brother's son	Cousin	0
Brother's daughter	Niece	−1

Same phrase, different gender! Always settle the speaker's gender and each link's gender before drawing the next link.

Swipe for a memory trick ⟶

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STUDY TRICK

Blood Relations: Decoding Relation Phrases

draw, don't guess

LEVEL, LINK, LOOK

Mark each person's generation relative to the base (...+2, +1, 0, −1, −2...). Take one link at a time. Look back at what is asked.

HOW TO ATTEMPT IT

1 Start from the speaker → 2 Take one phrase at a time →

3 Mark gender and generation → 4 Draw the tree →

5 Answer what is asked

EXAM TIP

If the question's answer depends on an unknown gender, check for a 'cannot be determined' or 'data inadequate' option.

DOUBT BUSTER

What if the gender of the person asked about is not given?

Use a gender-neutral word (sibling, cousin) if an option has it. If no option holds for both genders, choose 'cannot be determined' or 'data inadequate'.

Swipe for common mistakes →

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COMMON MISTAKES

Blood Relations: Decoding Relation Phrases

small slips, lost marks

✗ Calling mother's brother's son a brother

✓ He is a cousin. A brother is a son of the same parents.

✗ Treating 'my father's only son' as my brother when a male is speaking

✓ If a male is speaking, it is himself (no brother). If a female, it is her only brother. Fix the speaker's gender first.

✗ Calling mother's sister's husband a blood relation

✓ He is an uncle by marriage (mother's sister's husband / mausa), not a blood relation, though he is called uncle.

TOMORROW'S CA FOUNDATION MCQ TESTS THIS!
Revise it tonight, then try the MCQ.

Save this for revision!

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